

but an argument. By waiting until the simmering problem explodes into a crisis, it becomes difficult to approach the situation calmly and with a rational mind. This tendency to avoid discussion is why money tends to inflame so many passions and result in so many relationship crises.

Couples find that when they can resolve their financial difficulties and conflicts, their marriage or relationship usually improves. This is not to say that a lack of money problems guarantees a happy marriage, but it definitely results in less strain on the relationship.

This chapter will profile relationship financial problems, such as:

- Having incompatible money habits and goals
- Handling a partner's money addiction
- Believing that money buys love
- Avoiding communication about finances
- Assuming responsibility for joint debts
- Being too poor to divorce

Working as a team should be what relationships are all about. Having a financial direction that is proceeding along the same path, not in opposite directions or intersecting only occasionally, should be the ultimate goal. Unfortunately, many times one partner may be led down a path that is not of their choosing.

For Richer or for Poorer

Savers often end up married to spenders. Even if two partners have a similar money philosophy, one usually will end up as more of a saver and the other as more of a spender. Every couple needs someone who will set limits. Keep in mind that there may be subtle or extreme differences in these roles. For example, if two spenders marry, one may be a more conservative spender

